

loved the yard. Until very late in life, he spent almost a complete day each weekend in the bottom of the yard, which was almost wild but with spectacular oak trees and wildflowers. He would weed and tend to his wild-like garden and worry about all the things he fretted about, whether the stock market, politics, family matters, or whatever; and to him that time was a marvel, curative for everything annoying him. It was only as his dementia started, causing him to fall often, that he gave up the garden.

The late 1950's and the 1960's were the high point of Father's life, in my view. In 1958, *Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits* was published, making him an instant, national star. Locally, it made him sort of the dean of the San Francisco investment community. I doubt anyone had before received so much instant stature from an investment book. Certainly, tied to its era, Benjamin Graham's *Security Analysis* took much longer to become prominent. Local names that held sway in 1960 included Dean Witter, who founded and headed that great and locally- based brokerage firm. But to Dean Witter, New York was the mecca. And the public already fathomed that a broker was not a money man-ager. The then famous Gerald Loeb, also of San Francisco Jewish origin and also a broker, may have been bigger nationally, but he had long gone on to New York and lost the local link. Simply put, in San Francisco by 1960, there was no investment advisory name as noted as Father's. Different than today, all Northern California investing activities were geographically centralized in a few blocks around Montgomery and Bush Streets in San Francisco. In that realm Father held prestige of which he could have only fantasized in his insecure childhood.

There was a provision then in California state law, which still exists, allowing an advisor who maintained fewer than fifteen clients and did not hold himself out to the public as an investment advisor both to avoid Securities and Exchange Commission registration and to maintain contracts for compensation for a percent of profits that were otherwise made illegal in 1940, a point most investors don't appreciate today. Before then, scam artists would seek clients, tell half to do one thing, tell the other half to do the reverse, charge 20 percent of the profit on whatever happened, and pick up 10 percent of the spread no matter what happened. Hence percentage-of-profit contracts were illegal for all investment advisors for more than forty years unless the person had fewer than fifteen